

Generative AI is relatively new territory for me. Most of what I know comes from conversations, classes, videos, and things I hear from other artists and designers. I understand it as a technology that can generate new images, sounds, text, code, and other forms of content by learning patterns from large amounts of existing data. It is also possible to create databases to train these models, which I find quite fascinating. I took this class because I want to understand not only what generative AI can make, but also how artists are choosing to use it, resist it, or make it into something of their own. Because even though I am really excited about all the new possibilities of generative AI, I also have a lot of concerns about its effects and its future, as well as what it will mean to be an artist and make a living from it.

I spent three years studying classical Spanish guitar making and have spent the last two years making my own experimental guitars. It was mostly an analogue process (during which generative AI was making its way into creative fields). I realized that a huge part of my education happened in moments that would probably look like wasted time from the outside and that were definitely never paid for. Trying something that doesn't work. Getting frustrated. Getting bored. But generative AI seems very good at suppressing all of that, and only the final result gets seen. Are we going to stop valuing everything that AI makes invisible? Is there a way to use AI technologies without allowing efficiency to become the only measure of value?

One project that makes these questions particularly interesting to me is *Holly+*, by Holly Herndon and Mathew Dryhurst. They created an AI model trained on Herndon's voice that allows others to generate new vocals using a digital twin version of it. The whole process seems very intentional, and Herndon maintains agency over how her voice is used, shared, and transformed. This gave me hope cause it suggests that artists can participate in shaping this technology and the conditions surrounding its use.